01 / THE OBJECTIVE

A useful next step for Stride.

Grow installs without sacrificing subscriber quality.

Client context

Category: Health & Fitness

Account owner: Jordan Lee (fictional)

Review: Aug 22 - Sep 20, 2026

Data as of October 20, 2026

RECOMMENDATION: QUALITY REVIEW

The client reports weak subscriber quality despite rising installs. Request cohort-level trial-to-paid conversion and retention before increasing spend.

Start with the shared facts.

Advertiser spend	Tap-through installs	Average CPA, tap-through	Client CPA target
$16,677	**5,289**	**$3.15**	**$6.00**

Prior-period CPA: $3.20. Change: -1.6%.

Current installs include 4,538 new downloads and 751 redownloads.

The installation CPA is below the fictional target. The client reports weak subscriber quality, which these metrics do not resolve.

Current: Aug 22 - Sep 20. Prior: Jul 23 - Aug 21. Both periods are 30 days. Attributed installs do not establish incremental lift.

Install volume leaves a question open.

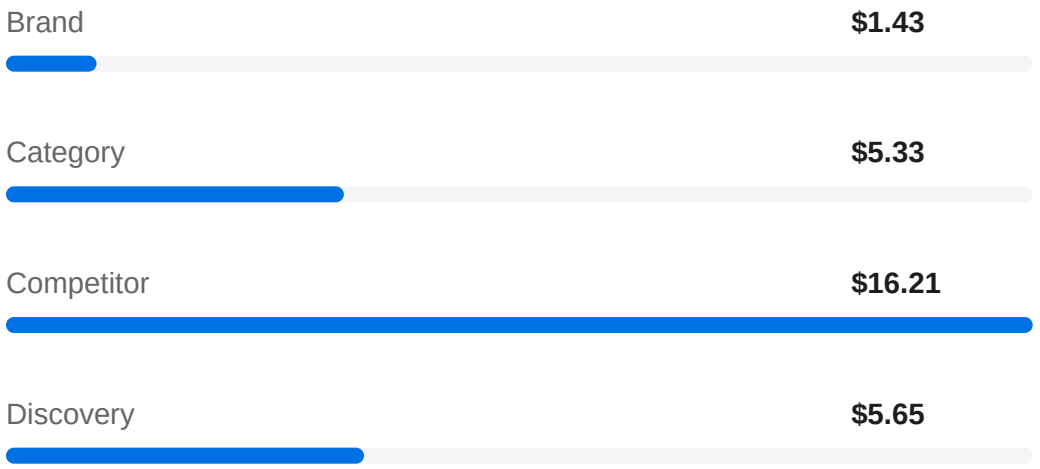
What we observe

Efficient installation costs coexist with a reported subscriber-quality concern. Do not infer retention, revenue, or payback from install reporting.

What we recommend

Hold expansion. Request matched cohort retention, trial-to-paid conversion, and payback evidence. Reconcile definitions with measurement partners.

Campaign CPA, tap-through



Different campaign themes serve different purposes. These comparisons identify questions; they do not prove a causal effect.

Thirty days. Four checkpoints.

Week 1

Validate

Confirm goals, reporting definitions, and the subscriber-quality concern.

Account team + client

Week 2

Resolve quality

Reconcile matched retention and trial-to-paid cohorts before proposing expansion.

Client partner + measurement

Week 3

Monitor

Review mature CPA, conversion, new-download mix, and available quality evidence.

Platform specialist

Week 4

Decide

Agree whether to extend, revise, or stop. Document the decision and evidence.

Client + account team

The cadence is 30 days. Final evaluation must allow attribution and post-install cohorts to mature beyond this cadence when needed.

Make the next meeting count.

01 What defines a valuable new user, and what acquisition cost supports that outcome?

02 Can we reconcile new downloads, retention, trial-to-paid conversion, and payback using comparable cohorts?

03 What evidence would justify additional budget, and what would make us stop?

Definitions: Apple Ads glossary and reporting documentation. All performance and client context in this review are synthetic.